



AMEERA SHAH
45, Executive Chairperson,
Metropolis Healthcare

FUTURE FOCUS

AMEERA SHAH, Promoter and Executive Chairperson of Metropolis Healthcare Ltd, exemplifies dedication. “I see myself as a guardian, responsible for providing wisdom and ensuring we stay aligned with our founding principles,” Shah shares. After overseeing the transition of Metropolis from a family-run business to a professionally managed, public company, she has helped increase the revenue share of digital to 20%, from zero before Covid-19. Besides, overall revenue reached ₹1,190 crore in FY24. For these reasons, she stays on the *BT* MPW list for the fourth consecutive year. **BT**

— **BY NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA**

ADVICE TO YOUNGER SELF

Prioritise investing in a strong technology foundation and building a talented team

MANTRA TO NAVIGATE CHALLENGES

Focus on actions rather than outcomes



ANANYA BIRLA
30, Founder and Chairperson, Svatntra Microfin

BUSINESS INSTINCT

ANANYA BIRLA CALLS the growth of Svatntra “sur-real”. From an average cheque size of ₹10,000 to an AUM of ₹14,437 crore at the end of March 2024, her venture has seen phenomenal growth. Add to that loan disbursement at a shade under ₹43,000 crore.

The story of how she started the micro-

finance venture at 17 is by now well-documented. “As a unit, we have endured and conquered challenging events like demonetisation and the pandemic,” says Birla. The success of Svatntra can be attributed to many factors, though she believes “consistently prioritising clients and placing them at the core of the operations” was

critical. Innovation flows from that principle. “That is driven by a profound comprehension of client needs coupled with a forward-looking strategy to adapt their behaviour to digitisation.”

It has also seen inorganic growth with the buyout of Chaitanya Fin Credit, propelling Svatntra to become the second largest NBFC-MFI in India. The ₹1,930 crore investment from Advent International and Multiples Private Equity followed, marking the largest private equity infusion in India’s microfinance sector. “This

ADVICE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF

Never stop learning. Hire people smarter than you

MANTRA TO NAVIGATE CHALLENGES

I see challenges as hidden opportunities

funding strengthens our mission of delivering accessible and responsible financial services to create a conducive environment for entrepreneurs who fuel India’s growth story,” says Birla, who also sits on the boards of Aditya Birla Management Corporation, Grasim and ABFRL.

The Chaitanya deal helped her understand that it is not just about combining assets. “It comes down to uniting visions and shaping the future of the industry.” By the looks of it, this growth story looks robust. **BT**

— **BY KRISHNA GOPALAN**